

Hi Everyone, welcome to the second Action Lab!

What are Action Labs? They're a house party for people who care—but are tired of feeling powerless and alone. We're here to connect, learn, and build clarity together. You'll walk away feeling better informed, more connected and with a better understanding-and practice talking about-our topic today-the Federal Court system.

Federal Court System-how it works and why you should care. I want to tell you why this topic is important to me. Donald Trump is pushing the boundaries of executive power and the constitution like no other president. Trump has pushed out almost 200 Executive Orders in 2025 so far, basically making new laws, skipping the legislative branch to do whatever he wants. Much of the fight against his overreach is showing up in our court systems. So I was curious about what this looked like, and what-if anything-I could do about it. The first thing I realized is that I don't really know much about how the Federal Court System works. So I started researching that. I am not a lawyer, just a concerned citizen who felt a great need to educate myself and open doors to this information to others. So you all will probably have plenty of questions that I can't answer, but maybe there are others in the room who can.

Our agenda today:

- a high level review of how the court system works
- then we'll dive into 2 very important cases happening today.
- Trump v CASA.
 - You might know this case as the Birthright Citizenship case, but in reality the case was about Universal Injunctions-a tool that's been used by judges to fight against Trump's power grab. The outcome of the Supreme Court decision changes judicial strategy and how the courts will fight against illegal and unconstitutional actions by Trump.
- California v Trump.
 - This is an ongoing case regarding Trump's taking over the California National Guard and sending military troops against protesters in LA after the Anti-Ice protests started. I chose this case because-quite frankly-the militarization happening in the United States is terrifying to me.

What I hope you walk away with today is a better understanding of how the Federal Court System works. How judicial strategy is changing. And how the judiciary can fit into political and legislative strategy.

I hope that you can pick up a newspaper, read about a court case and have a better understanding of the process and the impact.

We often think of the judiciary branch as something that we can't do anything about, but there are things you can do, so we'll leave some time for that at the end.

Take Action/Closing:

I love that you've all engaged with one another around some difficult topics. I hope that you'll be leaving here with the understanding that you're not alone in this. I hope that next time you look at a news article about an executive order or court case that you'll have a better context of what's happening and a framework to hang the new content from. I hope that the next time there's legislation about how the President can call up the military or judicial reforms that you'll have a viewpoint rooted in knowledge.

We're going to transition to action now-scattered around you'll see papers with tips on what you can do. You'll also see some slips of papers with the addresses of judges who have evoked universal injunctions as a way to stop Trump's illegal seizure of power. If you feel called, please grab some thank you cards and write to the judges. Judges are people too. They need to feel seen and appreciated and we need to add whatever forms of humanity and connectedness to our political system, so I thought writing thank you cards would be a healthy way for us to connect in that way. Good for us, good for them.

So please, grab some snacks, talk to your neighbors, donate some \$ to the ACLU if you feel called, write a thank you letter and let us know what you thought of this session!

We welcome any and all feedback and if you want to get involved with the creative journey of the next Action Labs come talk to me. If you want to sign up to be directly on Action Labs invitation list, sign up here and if you want to host a party like this for a group of your friends, then let me know! We can bring the dog and pony show if you provide the space. Also-we take requests-so if there's something that you'd like to learn more about-and discuss with other people-let me know what topics you'd like to cover and we can see if we can work them in to the next Action Labs!